

Olympic Committee (IOC) adhered to the rule book, allowing the athletes to compete as they complied with the required criteria. Khelif eventually went on to win gold in the welterweight category, while Lin claimed gold in the featherweight grouping.

During the year, India also decided to switch allegiance from the International Boxing Association (IBA) to World Boxing, following the former's tussle with the IOC.

Wrestling in India has been embroiled in a continuous spate of controversies over the past couple of years, and 2024 was no different. The National Wrestling Championships returned amid utter confusion — one event was held in Pune by some WFI officials, while another was conducted in Jaipur by the IOA-appointed ad hoc committee.

Double World Championship bronze medallist Vinesh Phogat competed in two weight categories in the Asian Olympic Games qualifier held in Patiala, emerging the winner in the lighter division. Bajrang Punia did not make it to the quadrennial event and was placed under suspension by the National Anti-Doping Agency (NADA) and United World Wrestling for his 'refusal' to provide a urine sample.

Aman Sehrawat won India's only wrestling medal at Paris 2024 in the 57kg category, becoming India's youngest Olympic medallist in the process. However, the wrestling competition in Paris was clouded by the unfortunate circumstances surrounding Vinesh.

The 30-year-old pulled off a major upset against reigning Olympic champion Yui Susaki of Japan on her way to becoming the first Indian woman wrestler to qualify for a final, securing at least a silver medal. But fate had other plans.

During the weigh-in ahead of the final, Vinesh was found to be 100 grams over the prescribed weight, disqualifying her from the



competition. An appeal to the Court of Arbitration for Sport also did not bear fruit. The excruciating circumstances had a profound impact on the wrestler, leading her to announce her retirement from the sport at the end of the Games. She went on to contest the Assembly Elections in Haryana, beginning her political career with a victory in the Julana constituency.

It was a case of too close yet too far for Mirabai Chanu in Paris, as the veteran weightlifter finished an agonising fourth in the women's 49kg event. The Tokyo 2020 silver medallist ended her attempts just one kilogram short of bronze medallist Surodchana Khambao of Thailand. India's Preetismita Bhoi and Bedabrat Bharali were declared the best lifters

Ascent against dissent: Despite calls to disqualify Algeria's Imane Khelif (in pic) and Taiwan's Lin Yu-Ting on the grounds that they supposedly failed a gender test, the International Olympic Committee (IOC) allowed them to compete. Both went on to win golds.

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at the 2024 IWF Youth World Weightlifting Championships in Lima. Preetismita broke the world record in the women's 40kg clean & jerk, while Bharali won gold in the 67kg category. In all, India won six gold, four silver, and eight bronze medals.

The inclusion of squash in the roster for the Los Angeles Olympics in 2028 was the highlight of the racquet sport in 2024. Veteran Saurav